

Moustafa Basiony

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Quantitative sociologist and mixed-methods researcher studying discrimination, social inequality, migration, and intergroup relations. Experienced in independently conducting survey-based research, preparing and analyzing complex social data, and developing reproducible workflows in R. Quantitative experience includes binary logistic and ordinal regression, interaction and moderation analysis, model diagnostics, sensitivity analysis, machine learning, computational text analysis, clustering, and survey-data analysis. Previous research experience includes analysis of U.S. Census data, collaborative manuscript preparation, and presentation of findings at academic conferences.

EDUCATION

KU Leuven Leuven, Belgium

MSc Sociology, Culture and Society Track | September 2026

Master's Thesis: Acceptance of Ethnic and Religious Discrimination among Adolescents in Dutch-Language Belgian Secondary Schools: The Role of Intergroup Contact, Migrant Background, and Discrimination Experiences

Supervisor: Prof. Dr. David De Coninck

- Conducted an independent quantitative study using survey data from 762 Belgian secondary-school students.
- Developed a reproducible R workflow for data cleaning, theoretically informed variable construction, missing-data assessment, analytic-sample construction, descriptive analysis, and reporting.
- Estimated separate binary logistic regression models for ethnic and religious discrimination, examining intergroup contact, perceived and vicarious discrimination, and migrant background.
- Tested interaction effects and compared model specifications using likelihood-ratio tests, AIC, odds ratios, and confidence intervals.
- Conducted model diagnostics and robustness analyses, including larger-sample sensitivity analyses and cumulative-link ordinal models.

Selected coursework: Quantitative Research Methods; Collecting and Analyzing Big Data for Social Sciences; Culture and Inequality; Advanced Qualitative Methods

Rutgers University-New Brunswick, New Brunswick, NJ, USA

B.A., Sociology; Minor: Cognitive Science. | January 2024

Summa Cum Laude | GPA: 4.0/4.0

Selected coursework: Social Research; Introductory Statistics in Sociology; Statistics 1; Introductory Computer Science; Cognition and Decision Making; Technology and Society

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Aresty Research Assistant | Rutgers University

September 2023 – May 2024

- Collaborated on research examining socioeconomic factors associated with mental and behavioral problems among children and adolescents during the COVID-19 pandemic.
- Cleaned and prepared large-scale U.S. Census datasets and conducted regression analyses using Stata and SPSS.
- Conducted literature reviews and synthesized research on socioeconomic inequality, family characteristics, and child well-being.
- Contributed to academic manuscripts and research reports.
- Presented findings at the Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention and Rutgers University research events.

SELECTED QUANTITATIVE AND COMPUTATIONAL PROJECTS

Web Scraping ICT Job Vacancies from Jobat | R, rvest, HTTP requests, regular expressions

- Helped develop and test a reusable R web-scraping workflow using rvest, HTTP requests, HTML parsing, and regular expressions to convert semi-structured vacancy listings into structured data.
- Extracted and cleaned job titles, locations, contract information, salary information, and job categories across multiple result pages.

Detecting Gender-Based Hate Speech on Reddit | R, supervised machine learning, text analysis, topic modelling

- Contributed to manual annotation, cleaning, and preparation of Reddit text data and assessed inter-coder agreement using Cohen's kappa.
- Compared Naive Bayes, logistic regression, and Random Forest classifiers using accuracy, precision, recall, F1-score, ROC-AUC, and external validation.
- Contributed to topic modelling and interpretation of themes within posts classified as hate speech.

Predicting Loneliness from Survey Data | R, PCA, clustering, machine learning

- Contributed to analysis of 37,775 survey responses using principal component analysis, K-means clustering, and hierarchical clustering.
- Compared logistic regression, Random Forest, and Naive Bayes classification models using multiple performance metrics.
- Evaluated classification-threshold tradeoffs in the presence of an imbalanced outcome.

Climate Migration Discourse on Twitter | R, computational text analysis, LDA

- Contributed to the analysis of 5,482 climate-migration tweets using text cleaning, sentiment and emotion analysis, and topic modelling.
- Conducted Latent Dirichlet Allocation and interpreted themes related to climate action, refugee and integration policy, and displacement.
- Contributed to validation of automated classifications and interpretation of methodological limitations.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PREPARATION

- Basiony, M. (2026). Acceptance of Ethnic and Religious Discrimination among Belgian Adolescents: The Role of Intergroup Contact, Migrant Background, and Discrimination Experiences.
- Basiony, M. (2026). The Sounds from Under the Stairs: Mahraganat, Class, and Cultural Legitimacy.

SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

- **Exploring the Influential Socioeconomic Factors on Mental and Behavioral Problems Among Children and Adolescents in the United States during the COVID-19 Pandemic.** Association for Psychological Science Annual Convention, San Francisco, 2024.
- **Examining the Relationship between Parental Sociodemographics and Children's Mental Well-being during the COVID-19 Pandemic.** 20th Annual Aresty Undergraduate Research Symposium, Rutgers University, 2024.
- **Panelist: Engaging Undergraduate Students in Research: From Cross-Discipline Programs to Published Articles.** Rutgers Active Learning Symposium, 2024.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Editorial Assistant Intern | Rutgers University Press

September 2023 – January 2024

- Proofread academic manuscripts and supported editorial and production workflows involving authors, editors, and production staff for sociology and history titles.

METHODS AND TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Quantitative:** Survey research; binary logistic regression; ordinal regression; interaction/moderation analysis; model comparison; model diagnostics; sensitivity analysis; missing-data assessment; principal component analysis; clustering; supervised machine learning; model evaluation
- **Computational:** Data cleaning and transformation; reproducible R workflows; web scraping; HTTP requests; HTML parsing; regular expressions; computational text analysis; sentiment analysis; topic modelling; data visualization
- **Qualitative:** Critical Discourse Analysis; qualitative research; mixed-methods research design
- **Software:** R (primary); Stata; SPSS; Python; Java
- **Languages:** English and Arabic (fluent); Spanish and German (intermediate)

AWARDS & HONORS

- Matthew Leydt Society Inductee, Rutgers University-New Brunswick, 2024
- Dean's List, Rutgers University-New Brunswick, 2021-2024
- SAS Academic Excellence Award, Rutgers University, 2023